MIG-29 FIGHTER JETS

Inducted: 1987 onwards

Numbers: **60 jets**

The Indian Air Force is modernising its MiG-29s with long-range missiles, and Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd signed a contract in March to produce RD-33 aero engines for its MiG-29s with significant indigenisation



SU-30 MKI

Inducted: 2002 onwards

Numbers: **260 jets**

The multirole fighter is the frontline fighter jet of the IAF. They are being built under license by HAL

SINDHUGHOSH-CLASS ATTACK SUBMARINES

Inducted: 1989 onwards

Numbers: **7**

The Soviet Kilo-class diesel-electric submarines have upgraded and refitted from 2014 with Indian participation



INS VIKRAMADITYA

Inducted: 2013

The modified Kiev-class aircraft carrier (originally named *Baku*) acquired from Russia has undergone refits and, along with the indigenously built INS *Vikrant*, is crucial to Indian Navy's plans to operate two carrier battle groups

S-400 TRIUMF AIR DEFENCE MISSILE SYSTEM

Inducted: 2021-23

Proposed no.: **5 squadrons**

India has received three squadrons so far. All five were scheduled to be delivered by early 2024, but delayed. Remaining two are expected by the end of 2026



KAMOV 226T HELICOPTERS

Proposed numbers: **200**

India signed a contract with Russia in 2015 to jointly produce the Kamov utility helicopters, but nothing has happened so far

KA-31 HELICOPTERS

Inducted in: 2003

Proposed numbers: **24**

The delivery of 10 KA-31 airborne early warning helicopters has been delayed by Russia since 2022. India operates 14 of them and needs 10 more for INS *Vikrant*



AK-203 ASSAULT RIFLE

Inducted in: 2024

Proposed numbers: **600,000**

India-Russia contract worth over Rs 5,000 crore signed in July 2021 for the joint manufacture of AK-203s by the Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited (IRRPL). So far, only 35,000 received

NUCLEAR SUBMARINE

India signed a $3 billion (Rs 25,119 crore) lease deal with Moscow in 2019 for the Bratsk, an Akula-class nuclear-powered attack submarine (to be named Chakra-3), but there has been no movement

in New Delhi, now heightened by the Russian military's competing demand for supplies for its battlefront in Ukraine.

Reflecting the mutual approach of keeping defence deals on the backseat, the two nations did not sign the long-awaited Reciprocal Exchange of Logistics Agreement (RELOS). The agreement would ensure mutual logistical support for military operations, and covers military exercises, training, port calls, humanitarian assistance and disaster relief efforts. There has been speculation that India, wary of US reaction to it, is hesitant to sign it. India signed a similar agreement with the US in 2016 as well as later with Australia and Japan–its three Quad partners. Such military logistics agreement is in place with France, Singapore and South Korea too.

"Given the risk of US sanctions on substantive new India-Russia defence deals and perennial Indian concerns with the quality and timely delivery of Russian equipment, observers should view defence technology cooperation emerging from Modi's visit as wrapping up of legacy projects (such as the S-400 and frigates) as well as expedient solutions to pressing shortfalls (such as the AK-203s)," says O'Donnell. However, he points to the reality that a vast majority of Indian military equipment remains of Russian/ Soviet origin, and Russia's historic support for technology transfer to India is reinforced by a defence industrial base in India geared toward producing Russian equipment.

India Looks Elsewhere

India's turning to countries like the US, Israel, France and Germany is aimed at reducing dependency on a single country and enhancing the quality of its arsenal. With worries over the deficiencies of Russian equipment, coupled with their less than ideal performance in the Ukraine conflict, India's need for state-of-the-art technology is deemed to be better met by western suppliers.

Today, the Indian military has advanced plans to make fighter jets with American and French engines, manufacture submarines with German and Spanish technology and buy jets from France for its aircraft carriers. Replacement of Russian-origin transport aircraft like the AN 32 and IL 76 with European and American aircraft is being considered too.

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY